

Smart Factory Integration Capstone

Propose and demonstrate a secure, scheduled, and resilient smart-factory system for an aerospace product.

Customer Lockwood Aerospace Manufacturing	Department Smart Factory Program	Difficulty Advanced	Time 3-5 class periods
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Production Goal: Design and defend an integrated aerospace manufacturing system.

Background

Lockwood Aerospace Manufacturing is selecting a team to design its next small smart factory. The proposal must integrate automation, data, quality, scheduling, packaging, cybersecurity, and contingency planning into one coherent system.

Learning Objectives

- Integrate technical and operational manufacturing systems
- Create production and information-flow models
- Use trade studies to justify decisions
- Present and defend a complete system proposal

Equipment

- ADM workcell and/or digital twin
- Layout and process-mapping tools
- Demand and capacity data
- Cybersecurity and risk templates
- Presentation software
- Engineering notebook

Student Instructions

- 1 Select one aerospace product or component from the provided options.
- 2 Define product specifications, demand, due dates, and quality checks.
- 3 Create a factory layout showing material flow, robot/conveyor stations, inspection, packaging, and shipping.
- 4 Create an information-flow diagram showing sensors, production data, operator inputs, and protected systems.
- 5 Develop a production schedule and calculate expected throughput.
- 6 Program or simulate one critical automated sequence.
- 7 Create a cybersecurity risk assessment with at least five controls.
- 8 Create a resilience plan for one machine failure and one supplier delay.
- 9 Build a decision matrix comparing your design with one alternate concept.
- 10 Present the proposal and answer questions from a review panel.

Engineering Requirements

- Meet the stated demand target or document the capacity gap
- Include automation, inspection, packaging, scheduling, cybersecurity, and resilience
- Provide at least one tested or simulated automation sequence

- Support major decisions with data or a trade study
- Include clear safety and reset procedures

Constraints & Safety

- Use available classroom tools and realistic capacity assumptions
- No safety or quality requirement may be removed to improve throughput
- Protect sensitive production data in the system design
- Presentation time is limited to eight minutes

Deliverables

- Factory layout
- Material and information flow diagrams
- Production schedule and throughput calculation
- Automation code or simulation evidence
- Cybersecurity risk plan
- Resilience plan
- Decision matrix
- Eight-minute presentation
- Reflection

Reflection Questions

- 1 Which subsystem most limited factory performance?
- 2 What tradeoff had the greatest effect on your design?
- 3 How did cybersecurity influence physical layout or workflow?
- 4 What would you validate before purchasing equipment?

Engineering Support

Engineering Tip

A strong smart-factory design connects physical flow, information flow, decision logic, and recovery planning.

Common Mistake

Adding more technology without defining interfaces and ownership can make a factory less reliable, not smarter.

Stretch Goal

Create a cost estimate and calculate the expected payback period for the proposed automation.

Career Connection

Smart manufacturing systems engineers integrate robotics, software, data, quality, cybersecurity, and operations.

Before You Submit

- Notebook evidence included
- Requirements checked
- Testing documented
- Reflection completed